Data Appendix: working notes and variable definitions

Tomás, drafted from the IR codebook (`IR_housing_codebook_v4.pdf`), the FAFSA extract documentation, and Hana's Slack messages. This should eventually become Appendix A of the paper. Corrections welcome.

A.1 Setting

- The University has six residential areas (A–F). Areas B and E are suite-style and cost more. Area D houses living-learning communities.
- Housing application in May: students rank the six areas and flag Honors College status. The Housing Office runs a computerized lottery **within blocks = first-ranked area $\times$ honors**, separately by cohort ($6 \times 2 \times 4 = 48$ blocks). Within a block, rooms are assigned at random.
- No roommate requests for first-years. Floor changes in the fall only for documented medical or safety reasons ($<1\%$).
- Each residential area has its own dining commons. Fall-semester meal plans are only valid in your own area's commons.
- Unit of peer exposure: floor $\times$ building $\times$ cohort. About 40 residents per floor; 628 floor-cohort units.

A.2 Variable definitions

Variable	Definition / source
Low-SES student	Pell-eligible in first year (financial-aid file). This is the analysis sample.
High-SES peer	Floor-mate whose parental AGI is in the **top quintile of the national parental income distribution** for their cohort (cutoff ≈$118,000 for the 2014 cohort; updated for each cohort using the published national quintile cutoffs). If there is no FAFSA (about 18% of likely high-SES students), status is imputed from the institutional aid application plus home-ZIP median income. Students between Pell and top-quintile are "middle" and are neither low- nor high-SES.
Treatment	$\text{HighShare}_{f(-i)}$ = share of i's floor-mates (excluding i) who are high-SES. Report per 10 pp.
Tie (network edge)	i and j swipe into the same building within 2 minutes of each other on $\geq$**10 distinct days** in a semester. Swipes at i's own residence-hall entrance are dropped. Dining commons, rec center and libraries are included.
Network sample	$\geq$5 ties in the semester.
EC$_i$	(share of i's ties who are high-SES) / 0.5, following Chetty et al. (2022). Year 1 = spring of first year; Year 3 = spring of third year.
Survey EC	Senior exit survey, "name up to five close friends at the University" (asked of a random half of respondents). Linked to aid records ⇒ share high-SES / 0.5.
Paid internship	Career-services records (student-reported + recruiting platform), any paid internship completed by the end of junior year.
Large-employer internship	Fortune 1000, federal agency, or top-50 consulting/finance.
Earnings at 25	State UI wage records, 7th calendar year after matriculation, 2024 $. Only students who consented to linkage. **Consent is collected at New Student Orientation (summer before matriculation), so it is pre-treatment.** In-state employers only.
High-wage firm	Employer in the top quintile of the state's firm-average-earnings distribution.
Home-county EC	County-level EC from the public Social Capital Atlas (socialcapital.org), matched via home ZIP → county.
First-generation	Neither parent has a bachelor's degree (admissions file).

A.3 Outcome list (as agreed on 12 May)

Academic: (1) first-year GPA, (2) cumulative GPA, (3) STEM or econ major, (4) business or econ major, (5) 4-year graduation, (6) 6-year graduation. Early career: (7) paid internship by junior year, (8) large-employer internship, (9) grad school by 25 (National Student Clearinghouse), (10) employed at 25, (11) earnings at 25, (12) employed at high-wage firm. **Total: 12.**

A.4 Notes to self

- Need a paragraph on how the IR de-identification works (hashed IDs; swipe data provided as pairwise co-swipe counts, not raw logs).

- Should we report the "middle" group (neither Pell nor top quintile)? About 27% of students. As it stands they only count in the denominator of HighShare.
- Cite the Social Capital Atlas data release properly.